

Stelios - Ervis Priftis

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ABOUT ME

I am a GIS Developer with 5 years of software development experience, specializing in Earth observation and geospatial web applications. I spent two years on the team behind the Copernicus Data Space Ecosystem Browser and EO Browser at Sinergise (later Planet Labs), and most recently delivered ZAGreen, a web-GIS platform for green-roof prioritization funded by the City of Zagreb. I combine front-end development (Angular, React, TypeScript) with a Python-based geospatial analysis toolkit (QGIS, GeoPandas, Rasterio). I am based in Slovenia and work remotely with international teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

DRONE MAPPING & GIS DEVELOPER — INDEPENDENT PROJECT (PRO BONO) – PRIVATE HOMEOWNER – 01/08/2026 – Current – TOLMIN, SLOVENIA

Drone survey and GIS digitisation of a newly purchased residential property (~770 m^2), delivering a measurable digital base map for the owners to plan and manage their land and buildings.

- Planned and executed an automated area-mapping mission with a DJI Mini 2 using Litchi, capturing nadir imagery of the full parcel
- Processed 106 nadir images in WebODM, generating a sub-centimetre orthophoto (0.85 cm GSD) and a 3D model of the house
- Georeferenced the orthophoto in QGIS against the official GURS national aerial orthophoto (Surveying and Mapping Authority of the Republic of Slovenia) as control reference, aligning the drone imagery to the national coordinate system (EPSG:3794, D96/TM)
- Designed a scalable multi-layer GeoPackage data model in QGIS (property boundary, land-use zones, structures) with auto-calculated areas and standardised attribute forms
- Digitised all parcel features from the orthophoto — buildings, roofs, gardens, paths — producing a catalogued map the owners can maintain and extend themselves

GIS DEVELOPER – LIST LABS D.O.O. – 01/02/2026 – 31/10/2026 – ZAGREB (REMOTE), CROATIA

Link : https://zagreen.listlabs.net/

Delivered ZAGreen, a web-GIS platform for green-roof prioritization in Zagreb (City of Zagreb 2025 open-data grant); ongoing contract covering maintenance, extensions, and upcoming projects.

- Processed Sentinel-2 imagery in QGIS, compositing NDVI from the hottest days of June–August 2025 and averaging into a single peak heat-stress raster; exported to GeoTIFF as the basis for a custom unvegetated index, then converted to Cloud-Optimized GeoTIFF with GDAL and served via GeoServer WMS
- Designed a five-phase Python analysis pipeline (GeoPandas, Rasterio, rioxarray, NumPy) implementing the unvegetated index, applied to 11,477 landuse zones and buffer zones around 132,167 buildings, plus a 70,855 flat-roof dataset from aerial LiDAR
- Built a bilingual HR/EN interactive web viewer (React 19, TypeScript, OpenLayers 10, Zustand, Tailwind) with 10 map layers, presenting the index scores as five Vegetation Priority tiers (Jenks natural-breaks classification)
- Led production delivery and infrastructure handoff: vector data served via PMTiles (Hetzner Object Storage), NDVI raster via GeoServer WMS, migration to LIST LABS systems (GitLab, Hetzner S3, GeoServer)

INDEPENDENT GIS DEVELOPER — PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT – SELF-DIRECTED – 01/10/2024 – Current – LJUBLJANA, SLOVENIA

Links : https://ember-lens.netlify.app/ | https://ember-lens.netlify.app/?mode=analysis&selectedEventId=213578&center=23.31895351409912,38.87002171064155

Ongoing self-directed professional development in GIS, combining structured learning with hands-on project work.

- Completed coursework in geospatial analysis, remote sensing, and GIS programming (Python, QGIS)
- Designed and built Ember Lens, an interactive wildfire visualization web map (Angular 19, MapLibre GL) covering European fire incidents from 2018–2025: EFFIS heatmap with time-range filtering, hectare-scaled point intensity, and fire-perimeter polygons
- Built a per-incident view with 3D terrain and hillshade, pre-/post-fire Sentinel-2 comparison (L1C/L2A via Sentinel Hub / Copernicus Data Space) with true-colour, false-colour infrared, and NDVI composites for inspecting burn-scar footprints, plus shareable event URLs preserving full map state
- Developed the technical foundation that led to the ZAGreen green-roof prioritization contract with LIST LABS d.o.o.

FRONT-END DEVELOPER — EARTH OBSERVATION PLATFORMS – SINERGISE D.O.O. (ACQUIRED BY PLANET LABS, 2023) – 01/08/2022 – 30/09/2024 – LJUBLJANA, SLOVENIA

Front-end development of the Copernicus Data Space Ecosystem Browser and EO Browser — open platforms providing free access to Copernicus Sentinel satellite mission data, built on the Sentinel Hub cloud platform.

- Developed and maintained responsive web applications using Sentinel Hub APIs, improving access to satellite imagery for researchers and environmental scientists worldwide
- Refined the user interface based on product and design team input, significantly improving usability of the Earth observation data ecosystem
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams on seamless integration of geospatial data services
- Continued in the role through the company's acquisition by Planet Labs (August 2023), working on the same Earth observation products

FRONT-END DEVELOPER – VALMORE TECHNOLOGIES – 01/04/2021 – 31/08/2022 – ATHENS, GREECE

Front-end development for Corvium Inc. (US food safety software company), engaged through Valmore as a development contractor.

- Developed and maintained CONTROL-PRO, Corvium's SaaS environmental monitoring and food-risk intelligence platform used by 100+ food producers across North America (later licensed to Neogen as "Neogen Analytics")
- Built data-driven dashboards for scheduling, mapping, and visualizing food safety diagnostic testing across production facilities
- Delivered new features and resolved issues using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, React, PHP and REST APIs
- Collaborated remotely with the US-based product team on compliance reporting and corrective-action workflows

PROJECTS

01/08/2026 – CURRENT

Tolmin Parcel — Drone Survey & GIS Mapping

Pro bono drone survey and GIS digitisation of a newly purchased residential property in Tolmin, Slovenia (~770 m^2). Flown with a DJI Mini 2 using an automated Litchi area-mapping mission; imagery processed in WebODM into a sub-centimetre orthophoto (0.85 cm GSD) and 3D model, georeferenced against the official GURS national orthophoto into the Slovene National Grid (EPSG:3794). All parcel features — boundary, land-use zones, structures — digitised in QGIS into a multi-layer GeoPackage with auto-calculated areas, giving the owners a base map they can maintain and extend themselves.

01/02/2026 – CURRENT

ZAGreen

Interactive web-GIS application that maps and ranks green-roof candidates across the City of Zagreb, Croatia, to support urban heat-island mitigation. Developed for LIST LABS d.o.o. under the City of Zagreb 2025 open-data grant program.

- Priority scoring based on NDVI vegetation analysis (Sentinel-2, Summer 2025): flat roofs surrounded by the least vegetation rank highest for greening potential
- Interactive map (React, TypeScript, OpenLayers) with 10 layers: NDVI overlay, potential flat roofs ranked from negligible to critical priority, landuse classification, buildings, boundary, trees (Zagreb Green Cadastre), live air quality, and a Destination Earth climate model, over OSM and orthophoto base layers
- Click-to-inspect popups, legend-based filtering, bilingual HR/EN interface

Link https://zagreen.listlabs.net/

01/10/2024 – CURRENT

Ember Lens — Wildfire Visualization Map

Personal project: a web map application for visualising wildfire incidents across Europe (2018–2025), built with Angular 19, ngx-maplibre-gl (MapLibre GL) and PrimeNG.

- Interactive heatmap of European fire incidents (2018–2025) with time-range filtering, based on EFFIS (European Forest Fire Information System) fire perimeters and hotspots; point intensity scaled by burned area (200–10,000+ ha)
- Per-incident view: fire boundary polygons with incident details (province, commune, burned area, date), 3D terrain view with hillshade, and pre-/post-fire Sentinel-2 imagery (L1C/L2A, via Sentinel Hub / Copernicus Data Space) with a before–after compare slider
- Multiple satellite layer composites: true-colour, false-colour infrared, and NDVI vegetation index for inspecting burn-scar footprints
- Shareable event URLs that restore the exact incident and application state

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SKILLS

JavaScript | TypeScript | Angular | JavaScript Framework | OpenLayers.js | Python (computer programming) | QGIS | web services | geographic information systems | cloud technologies | remote sensing techniques | handle geospatial technologies | use geographic information systems | apply digital mapping | evaluate spatial information | process spatial information | create GIS reports | cartography | Aerial photography | implement front-end website design

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

26/09/2016 – 16/12/2016 London, United Kingdom

WEB DEVELOPMENT IMMERSIVE — CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION General Assembly

Full-time immersive web development program (420 hours of instruction): front-end and back-end development, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, web application building, version control (Git), collaborative project work

01/09/2009 – 08/07/2011 Athens, Greece

VOCATIONAL TRAINING CERTIFICATE — SOUND TECHNICIAN I.E.K. AKMI (Private Vocational Training Institute)

Sound engineering and recording technology; audio equipment operation; studio and live sound techniques. 4-semester program (1,358 of 1,400 training hours completed)

Level in EQF EQF level 4

01/09/2006 – 30/06/2009 Athens, Greece

VOCATIONAL UPPER-SECONDARY SCHOOL DIPLOMA (EPAL) — ELECTRICAL INSTALLATIONS 1st Vocational High School of Athens (1ο EPAL Athinon)

Electrical installations; electrical engineering; technical drawing; health and safety.

Level in EQF EQF level 4

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): **GREEK**

Other language(s):

	UNDERSTANDING		SPEAKING		WRITING
	Listening	Reading	Spoken production	Spoken interaction	
ENGLISH	C1	B2	B2	B2	B2

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user; B1 and B2: Independent user; C1 and C2: Proficient user

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

Windsurfing, Snowboarding, Cocktail mixology, Thai boxing